

	BRAJVIDHYA SERVICES PRIVATE LIMITED 404, Saguna Arcade, Scheme No. 54 Commercial, PU-4, Vijay Nagar, Indore, Madhya Pradesh – 452010, India
	Procedure- Certification Decisions

1. PURPOSE

The purpose of this procedure is to define the certification decision process for the granting, extension of scope, modification, amendment, change, renewal, reduction, suspension, withdrawal, and transfer of certification within food safety certification schemes, ensuring compliance with the applicable requirements of ISO/IEC 17021:2015.

2. SCOPE

This procedure applies to all records related to certification activities.

3. REFERENCES:

BVSPL-QM-01 Quality Manual
ISO/IEC 17021:2015
ISO 9001

4. RESPONSIBILITY:

Technical Manager/ Quality Manager shall be responsible for implementing this procedure.

5. DESCRIPTION:

5.1 Certification Decision Committee:

5.1.1 The Certification Committee constitutes of the following ---- members

- a) Head Certification
- b) Managing Director
- d) Technical Expert/Technical Manager

5.2 The Certification Committee shall be responsible making certification decisions. The authority for all certification decisions shall remain with the designated Committee, including decisions related to the granting, continuation, renewal, extension, reduction, suspension, and withdrawal of certification.

6.0 Criteria for grant of certificate

6.1 A certificate issued to a site that has undergone an audit against ISO/IEC 9001 (Quality Management System – QMS) and has fulfilled the following minimum requirements:

6.1.1 The assessed site shall demonstrate compliance with the applicable requirements of the relevant standard within the scope for which certification is requested.

6.1.2 The client shall submit evidence confirming the closure of critical and major non-conformities. For minor non-conformities, an acceptable corrective action plan shall be provided. The submitted actions shall be reviewed by the Lead Auditor and subsequently evaluated and confirmed by the Certification Committee.

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Prepared By: Quality Manager	Approved By: Managing Director
Checked By: Technical Manager	Issue By: CB- Head Certification

6.1.3 The client shall possess established infrastructure and operational arrangements for manufacturing products and/or delivering services. The organization applying for certification shall be a legally registered entity or shall hold legal responsibility for the certified activities (such as a company incorporated under applicable legislation, government organization, registered cooperative body, or any other legally recognized entity).

6.1.4 The client shall have completed at least one complete cycle of internal audits and Management Review meetings as evidence of effective implementation and functioning of the management system.

6.1.5 The activities and scope of the client shall be included within the accredited scope of BV SPL.

6.1.6 The audit shall be performed by auditors and/or technical experts possessing the required qualifications, competence, and relevant experience.

6.1.7 The audit team shall provide adequate documented information and evidence to demonstrate fulfilment of certification requirements and suitability of the proposed certification scope.

6.1.8 The Certification Committee shall review and authorize the certification decision after assessing the adequacy and effectiveness of corrections and corrective actions related to all non-conformities.

6.1.9 All records and documents related to the certification process shall be completed, controlled, and retained as per the applicable document retention procedure.

7.0 Certification Decision

7.1 Following the satisfactory assessment of the audit file and verification of corrective action evidence by the Technical Manager, the Technical Review Report together with the relevant supporting records listed below, shall be presented to the Certification Committee for detailed review and final decision:

7.1.1 Audit Report

7.1.2 Non-conformities, including the client's responses.

7.1.3 Confirmation that the audit objectives and certification requirements have been satisfactorily met.

7.1.4 Certification recommendation indicating whether certification should be granted or not, including any applicable conditions, limitations, or remarks.

7.1.5 Decisions related to the renewal of certification shall be taken based on the findings of the recertification audit, evaluation of the management system during the certification period, and consideration of any complaints or feedback received from users of the certified status.

Note : If the certification body is unable to confirm the effective completion of corrections and corrective actions related to any major non-conformity within six months from the final date of the Stage 2 audit, an Follow up audit shall be performed before making a recommendation for certification.

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After obtaining approval from the Certification Committee, the certification decision along with the Certification Decision Meeting documentation shall be forwarded to the Administration/operational Department for processing and release of the certificate.

8.0 Drafting and Release of Certificate:

8.1 The Administration/Operations Department shall undertake the responsibility for preparing, processing, and issuing the certificate following receipt of the approved certification decision.

8.2 The certificate shall be generated based on the approved certification details and shall be verified for accuracy prior to release. Where deemed necessary, the draft certificate shall be submitted to the Certification Committee and/or Quality Manager/Technical Manager for review and confirmation to ensure that all information provided is correct and free from errors.

8.3 The certificate shall contain the following mandatory information:

8.3.1 Legal name and registered address of the organization/site granted certification;

8.3.2 Certified scope, including applicable products, services, processes, technologies, and operational activities evaluated during the assessment;

8.3.3 Unique certificate Number

8.3.4 Effective date of initial certification approval;

8.3.5 Certificate validity period and expiry date;

8.3.6 Signature of the authorized approving authority, i.e., Managing Director

8.3.7 Applicable accreditation symbol or accreditation mark;

8.3.8 Company Logo (BVSPL)

8.4 Certificates shall be issued with a validity period of three years from the date of the certification decision.

8.5 All certification fees raised through invoices shall be settled by the certified organization before the signed certificate is uploaded into the certification database and released to the authorized client representative.

8.6 After approval and authorization, the certificate details shall be entered into the database against the respective certificate holder's records. The database shall include information such as certificate number, date of issue, certified scope, and applicable assessment category.

8.7 BVSPL shall remain the owner of all certificates issued under its certification scheme.

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8.8 In case of suspension, withdrawal, or reduction of the certification scope, the client organization shall return the original certificate to BVSP as per the applicable certification policy and contractual terms.

9.0 Maintaining Certificate:

9.1 Continuation of certification shall be subject to the certified client's ability to demonstrate ongoing conformity and effective implementation of the management system during periodic assessments.

9.2 Any amendment, change, or expansion in the certification scope shall be evaluated and managed in accordance with applicable certification requirements.

10.0 Modification and extension in Scope of certificate

10.1 Certified clients seeking an extension to their existing certification scope shall submit a formal request/application to the Administration/Operations Team.

10.2 The submitted application shall be reviewed by the Certification Committee members to evaluate the feasibility and justification of the requested scope extension, with inputs from the audit team involved in the previous assessment, where required.

10.3 Quality/Technical Manager Review of documented evidence, additional assessment activities, or other necessary evaluations.

10.4 Where an additional audit is considered necessary, the assessment shall be conducted in accordance with the procedure.

10.5 The scope extension assessment may also be performed as part of the next scheduled surveillance audit, provided that the requirements for evaluation and verification are adequately addressed.

Note: After the extension of scope has been approved, the existing certificate shall be withdrawn from circulation and returned by the certified client. A revised certificate incorporating the extended scope shall then be issued as per the established certification procedure.

11. Record:

Document Name	Responsibility	Period
Master List	QM/TM	3 Years
Clients Files	QM/TM	3 Years